PathCopy Advanced 1.0 — quick guide

SketchUp 2024 / 2025 extension: copy groups and components along a path and sweep a railing profile along the same path

1 Installation

SketchUp → **Window** → **Extension Manager** → **Install Extension** → choose `pathcopy-advanced-1.0.0-eng.rbz` → restart SketchUp. Two buttons appear on the "PathCopy Advanced" toolbar — the tool and the settings panel — plus the **Extensions** → **PathCopy Advanced** menu. The build is unsigned: under **Extension Manager** → **Settings** the loading policy must be "Unrestricted".

2 Copy along a path

1. Start the tool. The **settings panel** opens with it.
2. Click an edge — that is the path. Neighbouring edges are picked up automatically, no welding needed; the walk stops at a junction. Clicking a face takes its outline. Ctrl+click adds another path; pre-selecting the edges works too.
3. Click the group or component to copy. Ctrl+click several objects — the copies will alternate.
4. Change anything in the panel — the copies rebuild in place. The whole session is **a single undo step**.

3 Distribution

Spacing	a fixed distance; the leftover goes to the start, the centre or the end
Count	exactly N copies over the whole length
Fit spacing	the nearest spacing to the given one that divides the path evenly
Fit per segment	a copy on **every vertex**, spacing fitted inside each segment — for railings
Vertices	one copy per vertex of the path

In the SketchUp measurement box: 1200 is the spacing in model units, 20x is twenty copies, 0 is one per vertex. Tab is the next mode.

4 Orientation

Follow path, in plan — turn by heading; *in 3D* — tilt with the slope; *path plane* — for a loop drawn on a wall; *keep orientation*. The Along / Across buttons set the object along the line or perpendicular to it. At a corner a copy stands square to the rail, not on the bisector. **Closed path**: copies face *outward* or *inward*, however the loop was drawn; on an open path the row is greyed out.

5 Railing

The **Railing along the path** checkbox sweeps a profile along the same path:

- **Section** — rectangular or round, width and height;
- **Alignment** — centred on the line, wholly outward or inward;
- **Raise** — lifts the railing to the top of the posts;
- **Extend the ends** — past the end points of the path.

Corners are mitred — a turn is a single piece with no gaps. The railing is built together with the copies and undone by the same Ctrl+Z; it can be built without copies too.

6 Finishing by hand

Click a placed copy to **turn it** by the given angle (90° by default), Shift+click turns it back. The turn survives any change of settings; Clear in the panel restores the common orientation. **Randomise** — random rotation, scale and shift within the given bounds; the same *seed* gives the same result.

7 Keys

Tab	distribution mode
↑ ↓	orientation
← →	where the leftover goes
Esc	one step back; removes the copies first
Right-click	all options, if the panel is closed

Note. Copies inherit the source's material, tag and scale. The tool binds no letter keys — in SketchUp a bare letter goes to your own shortcut. Settings are remembered; the second button reopens a closed panel. Version and authors — **Extensions** → **PathCopy Advanced** → **About...**